About this Book

This is a language book. It doesn't try to comprehensively detail libraries, frameworks, or other ancillary matters. Instead, it concentrates *only* on teaching the CoffeeScript programming language from syntax, through composition, to building, testing, and deploying applications. Although this book is full of complete, working programs, they're all manufactured (contrived, if you will) slaves to the core goal of helping you learn to program in CoffeeScript. You'll find this book to be a useful reference because of its breadth and depth, but it isn't comprehensive. The web made comprehensive programming references obsolete long ago.

If you want to learn the CoffeeScript *language*, then this book is for you. If, instead, you want to eschew that learning in favor of ready-made instructions for using CoffeeScript with one framework or another, then this is probably not the book for you. Although references to popular frameworks are given, this book concentrates on CoffeeScript as a language. This book balances server-side and client-side uses of CoffeeScript as appropriate to each individual topic.

Roadmap

This book follows a three-act structure in which you, the hero, journey to the heart of CoffeeScript before emerging with a thorough grasp of it.

Part 1 sets up your core understanding of the language. When you begin your apprenticeship in chapter 1, you'll learn the motivations for creating CoffeeScript and why you are embarking on your journey. In chapter 2 you'll be immersed in the syntax of the language and begin to absorb it. In chapter 3 you'll learn about functions from the ground up, and in chapter 4 you'll do the same with objects.

In part 2 you'll learn how to wield your new understanding of CoffeeScript. Chapter 5 will have you pulling apart objects and putting them together, and